Purshotamdas's vigorous campaign did much to increase public awareness of the currency problem and the ratio question was widely discussed. Hilton Young espoused his views in support of the 1s 6d rate in the columns of *The Financial Times* while in India, Sir Basil Blackett, the Finance Member, was the principal official spokesman. Purshotamdas in his rebuttal of the allegation in *The Financial Times* that he 'had adopted the tricks of the merchant class' pointed out that as early as 1899 two members of the Fowler Committee had advocated a rate of 1s 3d. He also warned that a higher rate would increase the burden on the Indian agriculturists. This was proved to be true in April 1926 (even before the Hilton Young Commission was published), when there were signs of weakness at 1s 6d and the government was forced to sell sterling at gold point. The price of cotton and jute fell and the balance of trade in favour of India dwindled to insignificant levels. Reverse councils were offered for sale and were unofficially put at £2 million. Purshotamdas was quick to point out that 1s 6d was a higher ratio than Indian agriculture could withstand.

Purshotamdas also corresponded with the Viceroy, Lord Irwin, on this subject and the letters on both sides were 'couched in friendly and earnest tones.'[9] In one such letter, written in December 1926, Purshotamdas asked the Viceroy to convene a special meeting of the Assembly to reconsider the policy of the Finance Department on the currency question. Lord Irwin replied that while he understood and recognized the importance of the questions raised by Purshotamdas, there was no change in the situation since the date of the report to warrant a reconsideration of his government's acceptance of the report, nor did he see any need for a special session of the Legislature. Sympathetic as he was, Lord Irwin was circumscribed by the official policy that Whitehall had decreed.

We have already seen how Purshotamdas had pointed out that the 1s 6d rate gave a 12.5 percent advantage to foreign manufacturers. Sir Basil Blackett countered by rather rashly suggesting that the higher ratio would save the Indian cultivator 12.5 percent on every sovereign worth of imported goods. Given the fact that many of the imports were luxury goods rather than necessities, this was a rather fatuous statement to make. His remark provided more ammunition to Purshotamdas's already smoking gun, who promptly reduced it to ridicule by asking how much of the silks, diamonds, and motor cars went to the cultivator. Purshotamdas added that